

AMPLIFY MEDIA GROUP

Amplora

Business Plan

*A multi-tenant local commerce and marketing platform
for newspaper publishers and the businesses they serve.*

DOCUMENT VERSION

v1 — Pilot launch plan with Phase 1.5 and Phase 2 roadmap

PREPARED

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CLASSIFICATION

Confidential — for partner and investor review

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Product: Amplora — Multi-tenant local commerce and marketing platform **Operated by:** Amplify Media Group **Status:** v1 — pilot launch plan with Phase 1.5 and Phase 2 roadmap **Date:** May 2026

1. Executive Summary

Amplora is a multi-product local commerce platform licensed to newspaper publishers in their territories. It replaces fragmented local internet resources — news, business directories, classifieds, jobs, real estate, inventory listings — with a single chat-driven interface backed by AI. The platform generates revenue through three layered product lines: an AI-powered marketing agent for local businesses, network-amplified display advertising, and inventory-vertical search for dealers with sellable inventory.

The strategic insight: digital agencies, national listing services (AutoTrader, Zillow, Indeed, Realtor.com), and ad platforms have absorbed revenue that newspapers historically captured. AI changes the cost structure for delivering marketing services. The publisher's existing relationships with local businesses and consumers are the trust layer no SaaS competitor can replicate. Amplora is the platform that returns this revenue to local publishers, with technology that wouldn't have been possible five years ago.

The phased rollout:

- **v1 (Year 1):** Marketing Agent — Tiers 1, 2, 3. Subscription pricing \$99/\$299/\$499 per month. Pilot launches with five businesses across Windom and Pipestone.
- **Phase 1.5 (Year 1–2):** Network-Amplified Display Advertising. Tiered reach pricing on display ads sold through publisher partners, with local-first algorithm protecting local advertiser primacy.
- **Phase 2 (Year 2–3):** Tier 4 Inventory Verticals. Auto, ag equipment, real estate, RV/boat, lumber yards. Subscription tiers \$799–\$1,999+ per month, integrated with existing dealer inventory management systems.

Year 1 ARR target: \$105k–\$150k. Year 3 ARR target across all three product lines: \$1.5M–\$3M as inventory tier revenue compounds.

2. Business Concept and Mission

Mission: Restore the local newspaper's role as the commerce hub for its community — the place where businesses get marketed, ads reach the right audience, and consumers find what they're looking for — modernized through AI to deliver agency-quality work and search-engine-grade discovery at price points local economies can support.

The pitch in one sentence: "Your local newspaper is now a commerce platform. We market your business, sell your ads, and put your inventory in front of every shopper in the region — at a price that actually works for a small-town economy."

Strategic role of each product line within Amplora:

The Amplora chatbot is the **discovery layer** — the consumer-facing surface and the platform's central moat. The marketing agent is the **service layer** — recurring service revenue from local SMBs. Display advertising with network amplification is the **transactional ad layer** — leveraging the publisher sales motion and the chatbot reach. Tier 4 inventory verticals are the **commerce layer** — high-value subscriptions for businesses whose product is searchable inventory.

Publisher partners are the **sales and trust layer**, licensed to operate the platform in their territories. Amplify Media Group holds the platform layer and a national ad network above it.

3. Product / Service Description

3.1 Marketing Agent — v1 Product (Tiers 1, 2, 3)

Tier 1 — Network Presence (\$99/month)

- Full business profile in the Amplora chatbot
- Ads, articles, and editorial mentions ingested into chatbot knowledge base
- Basic listing: hours, services, location, contact, photos
- Auto-generated `/pricing.md` and `/llms.txt` for AI discoverability across external assistants (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Claude)
- Real-time updates pushed to chatbot
- *Cold-start consideration: introductory \$29/month for first 90 days of pilot to seed chatbot data density*

Tier 2 — Marketing Agent (\$299/month)

Everything in Tier 1, plus:

- AI voice interview onboarding (~30–45 minutes, conducted by AI agent, produces a canonical Product Marketing Context file for the business)
- Custom marketing plan generated post-interview, owner approves in dashboard
- Social media content produced and scheduled across Facebook, Instagram, and other platforms appropriate to the business
- Google Business Profile management — posts, photos, Q&A, attribute updates, holiday hours
- Reviews monitoring on Google and Facebook with AI-drafted owner responses
- Website — new hosted business page provided OR integration with existing site
- Owner approval workflow with thumbs up/down and edit option

- Monthly performance dashboard
- Ad spend recommendations (\$200/month minimum recommended; v1 produces campaign briefs that owner or media buyer executes)

Tier 3 — Marketing Agent + Business Concierge (\$499/month)

Everything in Tier 2, plus:

- Dedicated business chatbot delivered as a focused conversation mode within the Amplora chatbot — when a customer picks a business, they enter a deep conversation about that business's products, services, hours, scheduling, and FAQs
- Owner escalation — chatbot can hand off to the owner via SMS or push notification when conversations require human attention
- Competitive intelligence — monthly report on what competing businesses in the territory are posting and promoting
- Quarterly business review with publisher rep
- Higher-priority quality monitoring

3.2 Network-Amplified Display Advertising — Phase 1.5

When publisher partners sell display advertising into their publication, Amplora adds a new layer of value: configurable network reach into other licensed territories through their chatbots. The advertiser pays more for broader reach, the selling publisher keeps the majority of the revenue, and the chatbot algorithm always prioritizes local results so no local advertiser is displaced.

Reach Tiers

- **Local Reach** (default, included in standard ad rate): selling publication + that territory's chatbot
- **Regional Reach** (+50% of base ad rate): adds chatbot reach in adjacent territories within 50 miles
- **Network Reach** (+100%): chatbot reach across full network within 100 miles
- **Maximum Reach** (+150–200%): every licensed territory

Example: a \$200 nursing help-wanted ad in the Windom Pilot becomes \$300 for regional, \$400 for 100-mile, \$500–600 for network-wide. The advertiser sees exactly what they're paying for.

The Local-First Algorithm

This is the rule that makes everything else work. Hard-coded behavior in the chatbot:

- **1.** Local results always surface first — any ad or listing in the user's home territory shows above any out-of-territory result, full stop

- **2.** Adjacent territories surface next when local results are thin or when the user explicitly asks for broader range
- **3.** Out-of-territory paid-reach ads appear only when (a) the advertiser paid for reach covering the user's location, and (b) local results don't fully answer the query
- **4.** Distance is always disclosed — out-of-area results are labeled clearly ("Hadley, 35 miles from you") rather than blended deceptively

The advertiser-facing framing: *"Your ad is always seen first by people in your own territory. Network reach is for getting in front of additional eyes after your local audience has been served."*

Where Reach Actually Sells

Train sales reps to know where reach upsells make sense:

- **High value:** help-wanted ads (regional commute pool), real estate, auto sales, ag equipment, professional services with broad geography
- **Medium value:** unique retail (boutiques, specialty stores), event promotion, services with regional draw
- **Low value:** restaurant specials, hyper-local services, corner store promotions

Simple rule: if the advertiser would happily drive customers in from 50 miles away, sell them the reach.

3.3 Tier 4 — Inventory Verticals — Phase 2

Inventory turns the chatbot from a directory into a search engine for things people actively shop for. "What 4-bedroom houses near Marshall are under \$300k with a basement on at least an acre?" is a query someone runs dozens of times during a buying journey. Inventory dramatically increases chatbot engagement, which makes every other product line more valuable.

Verticals That Fit, Ranked by Urgency for Southwest Minnesota

- **Auto dealers** (new and used) — every town has 2–5; high willingness to pay; established inventory management systems (DealerCenter, vAuto, AutoBase, AutoUplink) with feed APIs
- **Ag equipment dealers** — major presence in this region (John Deere, Case IH, Kubota); established platforms like TractorHouse with inventory feeds; deal sizes \$20k–500k+
- **Real estate brokerages** — MLS integration is the path; compliance is real but worth the work
- **RV, boat, powersports dealers** — seasonal but high deal sizes
- **Lumber yards / building supply** — inventory plus stock-on-hand and specials
- **Heavy equipment / construction** — niche but high-value listings

How Tier 4 Works

Consumer experience: someone asks the chatbot "any dealers in southwest Minnesota have a red 2024 Honda Civic under \$30k?" The chatbot returns matching inventory across all participating dealers within a configurable radius — photos, price, dealer name, distance, contact path. Click through or start a chatbot conversation about that specific vehicle.

Dealer experience: full integration with their existing inventory management system for auto-sync, or a manual upload dashboard for dealers without one. Photos, specs, pricing, and status (available/sold/pending) update automatically.

Tier 4 Pricing Structure

Inventory size varies massively, so pricing is tiered by capacity:

- **Tier 4 Base — \$799/month:** everything in Tier 3, plus inventory integration up to 50 listings, automated feed import from one supported management system
- **Tier 4 Plus — \$1,299/month:** up to 250 listings, two-system integration, multi-location support
- **Tier 4 Enterprise — \$1,999+/month:** unlimited listings, custom integrations, multi-state where relevant

Market context: AutoTrader Premier (\$300–1,000/month per dealer), Zillow Premier Agent (\$300–3,000/month per agent), Realtor.com Showcase (\$300–2,000/month). Our pricing slots competitively while delivering the publisher-relationship moat the national listing services don't have.

3.4 V2 Roadmap

- Autonomous ad spend management (agent OAuth into Meta Ads Manager and Google Ads, executes within approved budgets)
- Email and SMS marketing
- Referral network for photography and video
- Expanded analytics and ROI attribution
- Multi-tenant learning across customers (anonymized insights propagate by vertical and territory)

4. Market Analysis

4.1 Marketing Agent Target Customer

- Local SMBs in rural and exurban Minnesota markets
- Typically 1–2 person operations (owner-operator)

- Annual revenue \$50k–\$1M
- Currently doing little organized marketing, OR maintaining a stale Facebook page, OR relying on a family member
- Cannot afford a marketing hire (\$30–50k/year) or digital agency (\$500–2,000/month)

4.2 Pilot Territory — Southwest Peach Group

- Communities: Westbrook, Marshall, Pipestone, Windom, surrounding areas
- Estimated 200–400 active local businesses across the territory
- 10% penetration = 20–40 customers; 20% penetration = 40–80

4.3 Easy Verticals for V1 Marketing Agent

General retail, restaurants and coffee shops, salons and barbershops, auto repair (not sales), home services (plumbing, HVAC, electrical, landscaping), pet services, fitness studios, florists, photographers, dance studios, hardware stores. The pilot cohort is drawn from this list.

4.4 Inventory Verticals Market — Phase 2

- Estimated 8–15 auto dealers across SW Peach territory
- 3–6 ag equipment dealers
- 50+ real estate agents and 4–8 brokerages
- Combined Phase 2 TAM in pilot territory alone: 80–120 inventory-tier customers
- Average revenue per customer at \$1,000+/month: \$80k–\$120k+ MRR potential at full territory penetration

4.5 Display Advertising Market — Phase 1.5

The selling publishers already operate display ad sales motions in their publications. Network amplification is incremental revenue on top of existing sales, not net-new acquisition cost. Estimated 200–400 display ad transactions per month across SW Peach territory; even modest reach-tier upsell rates (15–25%) create meaningful incremental revenue.

4.6 Competitive Landscape

Marketing Agent competitors:

- DIY tools (Hootsuite, Sprout Social, Constant Contact): require user expertise and time
- Local digital agencies (\$500–2,000/month): too expensive for most SMBs in this market

- Freelance social media managers: variable quality, hard to find locally
- AI-native marketing startups: emerging, mostly aimed at urban SMBs, lack local context
- Status quo: most local SMBs do nothing or maintain stale Facebook pages

Inventory tier competitors:

- AutoTrader, Cars.com, CarGurus (auto)
- Zillow, Realtor.com, Redfin (real estate)
- TractorHouse, Equipment Trader (ag and heavy equipment)
- These platforms charge meaningful fees and have no local trust relationship

Display ad amplification competitors:

- Indeed, ZipRecruiter (jobs)
- Facebook Marketplace, classifieds aggregators
- None offer the publisher-affiliated, locally curated reach

4.7 Industry Trends

- Newspaper revenue decline creating urgency for new product offerings
- AI making marketing automation viable at SMB price points
- Local search and AI-discovery rising in importance over generic social posts
- Consumer fragmentation across platforms creating discovery problems
- Rising consumer skepticism of big-tech platforms, opening space for trusted local intermediaries

5. Unique Selling Proposition

The platform is structurally different from any single competitor along five axes:

- **Publisher relationship** — the local newspaper is already the trusted intermediary for both businesses and consumers in these markets. No SaaS or national listing service competitor can replicate that trust.
- **Local market intelligence** — the agent and the chatbot know the town, school calendar, local events, weather patterns, seasonal rhythms, and what works in this specific market.
- **Exclusive Amplora chatbot integration** — the only platform that places businesses, ads, and inventory inside the local AI search/discovery layer simultaneously.

- **Three layered revenue lines from one platform** — marketing services + ad amplification + inventory search — each making the others more valuable.
- **Local-first algorithm** — the protection mechanism that lets the network expand without cannibalizing local advertiser primacy.

The narrative pitch: not "AI does your marketing" (commodity) but "your local newspaper is now a commerce platform — we market your business, sell your ads, and put your inventory in front of every shopper in the region." The publisher relationship is the moat. The AI is the cost structure that makes it viable.

6. Marketing and Sales Strategy

6.1 Sales Channel

- **Primary channel:** licensed publisher partners and their existing local sales staff
- **Pilot phase:** Amplify Media Group and publishers co-sell the marketing agent
- **Post-pilot:** publisher sales staff run the motion with co-selling on first 5 customers per territory
- **Phase 1.5 ad reach:** layered into existing publisher display ad sales — incremental upsell, not new motion
- **Phase 2 inventory tier:** dedicated solution sales motion required given larger deal size and integration complexity; may need a regional sales lead by Phase 2 launch

6.2 Sales Kit Required for Launch

- Pricing sheet covering all tiers
- Live demo (voice interview, dashboard, sample content, Amplora chatbot integration)
- Recorded demo backup
- Pitch script with objection handling
- Sample voice interview snippet
- Sample monthly performance report
- Contract package with T&Cs
- Setup fee credit-back explainer
- Reach Calculator for Phase 1.5 ad sales (project impressions and pricing across territories)

6.3 Customer Acquisition

- Anchor publisher promotion: in-paper ads, editorial coverage of the pilot, demo events
- "Coffee and chatbot" demo events for local business owners
- Case studies from first pilot customers
- Cross-promotion: Amplora chatbot surfaces Tier 2/3 businesses prominently
- Referral program: business that refers a paying customer gets one month free

6.4 Consumer-Side Marketing — Critical Dependency

The marketing agent's value, ad amplification, and inventory tier ALL depend on the Amplora chatbot having real consumer adoption. Without consumers using the chatbot, the entire value chain collapses. This work runs in parallel with v1 launch, not after.

Target: 1,000+ active monthly users on the chatbot in pilot territory within 90 days of launch.

Tactics: in-paper promotion with publisher partners, local social media campaigns, partnerships with schools and chambers and libraries, demo events for both consumers and businesses, PR push at chatbot launch, local radio/podcast sponsorships.

7. Pricing and Revenue Model

7.1 Marketing Agent Subscription (Tiers 1–3)

- Tier 1: \$99/month
- Tier 2: \$299/month
- Tier 3: \$499/month
- Setup fee: \$299–499 credited back after 90 days of subscription
- Concierge setup add-on: \$199–299 one-time, for businesses needing help with OAuth flows and account integrations
- Recommended (not required) ad budget: \$200/month for Tier 2/3
- V2: 10–15% media management fee on agent-managed ad spend

7.2 Display Ad Reach Pricing (Phase 1.5)

Multipliers on the publisher's standard ad rate:

- Local Reach: included (1.0×)

- Regional Reach (50 miles): 1.5×
- Network Reach (100 miles): 2.0×
- Maximum Reach (full network): 2.5–3.0×

Cross-territory revenue split when an ad sold by Publisher A appears in Publisher B's chatbot territory:

- Selling publisher (A): 65%
- Receiving publisher (B): 25%
- Platform: 10%

When the ad runs in three or more territories, the receiving share is divided proportionally to chatbot impressions actually delivered. This rewards publishers who build real chatbot consumer adoption.

7.3 Tier 4 Inventory Subscription (Phase 2)

- Tier 4 Base: \$799/month
- Tier 4 Plus: \$1,299/month
- Tier 4 Enterprise: \$1,999+/month

Annual contracts standard; setup fee \$999–2,499 (credited back after 90 days) reflecting the integration work involved.

7.4 Contract Terms (All Tiers)

- Annual contract
- 30-day opt-out window opens at day 90
- Setup fees credit-back at day 90
- Renews annually unless cancelled in opt-out window

7.5 Publisher Revenue Share

Marketing Agent subscriptions:

- 50% to publisher in year one
- 40% to publisher on renewals (lower work to retain than to acquire)
- 60% performance tier available for publishers hitting retention/volume thresholds

Display ad reach (Phase 1.5): 65% to selling publisher, 25% to receiving publisher(s), 10% platform — described above.

Tier 4 inventory (Phase 2): 50% to publisher in year one, 40% on renewals; same structure as marketing agent. Larger deals may warrant deal-by-deal negotiation.

Ad spend is pass-through (no rev share); future media management fee split 50/50.

8. Operations Plan

8.1 Operating Model — AI-First with Designed Escalation

Default path is fully automated — voice interview, plan generation, content production, scheduling, dashboard reporting, and owner approval all run through AI with no human touch. Three escalation triggers route to human:

- Quality monitoring AI flags anomalies → human reviews
- Owner-initiated escalation via dashboard "talk to a human" → response within one business day
- Setup-failure auto-route at day 14 → human concierge

This model holds at 5 customers, scales to 50, and remains efficient at 500.

8.2 The Local-First Algorithm

This is operational discipline as well as a sales tool. Hard-coded into the chatbot's ranking logic:

- **1.** Local results surface first by default
- **2.** Out-of-territory paid-reach results surface only when the advertiser paid for reach covering the user's location AND local supply doesn't fully answer the query
- **3.** Distance is always disclosed
- **4.** User can explicitly opt into broader-range results

This rule applies equally to display ad amplification (Phase 1.5) and inventory results (Phase 2). It is the principle that lets the network grow without cannibalizing local advertiser primacy.

8.3 Tech Infrastructure

- Multi-tenant database (per existing project specification)
- DigitalOcean Gradient AI Platform with Llama 3.3 70B serverless inference
- Sub-agent architecture: voice interview agent, content drafter, hook writer, source verifier, knowledge gap detector, content audit agent, quality monitoring meta-agent, ticket triage, etc.
- OAuth integrations: Meta Business, Google Ads, Google Business Profile (read-only v1, full v2)

- Amplora chatbot — knowledge base architecture, general discovery mode, business-focused conversation mode, owner notification path
- Auto-generated `/pricing.md` and `/llms.txt` for every business profile (network-level moat)
- Stripe billing
- Voice transcription pipeline
- Approval workflow service
- **Phase 1.5 additions:** ad reach configuration, cross-territory revenue tracking, reach calculator
- **Phase 2 additions:** inventory feed integrations (one per supported management system), faceted search infrastructure, inventory photo handling at scale, real-time sync, multi-location handling

8.4 Industry Guardrails (V1)

Excluded — do not sell to in v1:

- Healthcare and medical practices (HIPAA, FDA marketing rules)
- Legal services (state bar advertising rules)
- Financial advisors, investment services, cryptocurrency (SEC/FINRA)
- Cannabis and CBD (platform-banned, varies by state)
- Firearms (most platforms ban paid ads)
- Adult, dating, gambling

Sell with care — extra guardrails:

Restaurants and bars (alcohol age-gating, menu claims), insurance (state-by-state rules), real estate (Fair Housing Act), auto dealers (FTC car advertising rules), pharmacies/supplements (FDA on health claims), education and tutoring (outcome claims).

Easy verticals (pilot focus): retail, restaurants, salons, auto repair, home services, pet services, fitness, coffee shops, florists, boutiques.

8.5 Compliance and Disclosure

- AI-managed content disclosure on social posts (small "managed by [Business Name]" footer)
- AI chatbot disclosure to consumers when interacting with business chatbot
- No fabricated testimonials or reviews (FTC enforcement is active)
- T&Cs covering owner accountability for factual accuracy, indemnification, AI scope of authority, termination

- Privacy policy covering voice interview data and chatbot logs
- Data Processing Agreement with publishers as data processors
- For Phase 2: inventory accuracy disclaimers, MLS compliance for real estate, dealer-specific advertising compliance
- Pre-launch legal review required at each phase

8.6 Team and Roles

Core team (v1):

- Trevor — CEO, business lead, publisher relationships, UX/UI design
- Nate — CTO, technical lead, news-side chatbot
- Homer (AI coding agent) — primary build executor
- John Draper — pilot publisher partner / advisor (Pipestone County Star)
- Contractor: human concierge / quality reviewer (from month 1–2)

Hiring plan:

- Month 6: customer success lead (full-time or fractional) at ~25 active marketing agent customers
- Month 9: business development / publisher partnerships lead
- Month 12: second engineer
- Phase 2 launch: regional sales lead for inventory tier
- Designer: contracted as needed

9. Financial Projections

Note: Projections are illustrative based on the pricing structure and cost assumptions discussed. Actual numbers should be validated against detailed cost modeling.

9.1 Revenue Streams

- Marketing agent subscriptions (Tiers 1–3): \$99–\$499/month per customer
- Display ad reach upsells (Phase 1.5): incremental revenue layered on existing display ad sales
- Tier 4 inventory subscriptions (Phase 2): \$799–\$1,999+/month per customer
- Setup fees (subject to credit-back at day 90)
- Future: media management fees, photography referral commissions

9.2 Year 1 (May 2026 – April 2027)

- Months 1–3: pilot phase, 5 marketing agent customers
- Months 4–8: SW Peach expansion, 15–25 marketing agent customers
- Months 9–12: 35–50 marketing agent customers
- Phase 1.5 ad reach launches in months 9–12 with ~\$5k–\$15k incremental revenue
- Year-end ARR (marketing agent): \$105k–\$150k
- Year-end Phase 1.5 incremental: \$5k–\$15k
- Setup fee revenue: \$15k–\$25k (held as deferred until day-90 retention achieved)

9.3 Year 2

- 100–150 marketing agent customers across 2–3 licensed territories
- Phase 1.5 fully operational: \$30k–\$80k incremental annual revenue
- Phase 2 inventory tier soft-launches in second half — 5–15 Tier 4 customers
- Year-end ARR (marketing agent): \$300k–\$450k
- Year-end ARR (Phase 1.5): \$30k–\$80k
- Year-end ARR (Tier 4): \$50k–\$200k
- **Total Year 2 ARR: \$380k–\$730k**

9.4 Year 3

- 300–500 marketing agent customers across 5–7 territories
- Phase 1.5 fully scaled: \$150k–\$300k annual revenue
- Phase 2 inventory tier in production — 30–80 Tier 4 customers
- Year-end ARR (marketing agent): \$900k–\$1.5M
- Year-end ARR (Phase 1.5): \$150k–\$300k
- Year-end ARR (Tier 4): \$300k–\$1.2M
- **Total Year 3 ARR: \$1.35M–\$3.0M**

9.5 Unit Economics — Tier 2 Reference Customer

- Revenue: \$299/month

- Publisher share (year 1): \$150/month
- AI inference and infrastructure: ~\$10/month
- Allocated platform/support/concierge: ~\$30–50/month
- **Contribution margin: \$90–110/month**
- Estimated 24-month average tenure
- Lifetime value (year 1 cohort): \$2,200–2,600

9.6 Unit Economics — Tier 4 Base Reference Customer

- Revenue: \$799/month
- Publisher share (year 1): \$400/month
- AI inference and infrastructure: ~\$30/month (higher due to inventory volume)
- Allocated platform/support: ~\$80–120/month
- **Contribution margin: \$250–300/month**
- Estimated 36-month average tenure (higher switching costs)
- Lifetime value: \$9,000–10,800

9.7 Cost Structure and Break-Even

- Estimated v1 build + year-1 operating costs: \$75k–\$125k
- Phase 1.5 incremental engineering and operating cost: \$15k–\$30k
- Phase 2 incremental engineering and operating cost: \$150k–\$300k (heavier integration work)
- Break-even on combined platform: ~75–100 active marketing agent customers OR Phase 1.5 + 25–40 marketing agent customers OR 15–25 Tier 4 customers
- Combined break-even achievable in late year 2 with disciplined execution

9.8 Cash Flow Considerations

- Annual contracts collected upfront where possible improve cash position
- Setup fees track as deferred revenue, not earnings, until day 90 retention achieved
- Publisher revenue share paid monthly on collected revenue
- Ad spend is pass-through and should not flow through P&L as revenue

10. Risk Analysis and Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Amplora chatbot consumer cold start	High	Aggressive consumer-side launch marketing; promotional Tier 1 pricing to seed listings; in-paper editorial support
Publisher fails to execute on sales	High	Clear performance tier in rev share; defined onboarding and sales kit; co-selling in early months
AI quality issues at scale	Medium	Quality monitoring meta-agent; concierge fallback; staged rollout
Regulatory shifts on AI disclosure	Medium	Conservative disclosure practices from day one; ongoing legal counsel
Ad platform compliance	Medium	V1 defers autonomous ad spend; agent recommends, owner/operator executes
Cross-territory revenue disputes (Phase 1.5)	Medium	Clear written allocation rules in publisher agreements before Phase 1.5 launch; transparent attribution dashboard
Inventory accuracy failures (Phase 2)	High	Real-time feed sync requirements in dealer contracts; clear "as-of" timestamps in all listings; disclaimers; rapid sold-status updates
Tier 4 integration cost overrun (Phase 2)	High	Sequence vertical-by-vertical; auto first, then ag, then real estate; do not commit to multi-vertical Phase 2 launch in single quarter
Unit economics worse than modeled	Medium	Monthly review; pricing flexibility on Phase 2 pricing as integration costs become clear
Key person risk	Medium	Documentation discipline; cross-training; advisor bench

Risk register reviewed monthly through pilot, quarterly thereafter.

11. Action Plan and Timeline

Phase 0 — Pre-Launch (Months 0–2, May–June 2026)

- Sign publisher partnership agreement with Pipestone County Star
- Complete Homer build of v1 marketing agent platform per specification
- Recruit 5 pilot businesses (3 Windom, 2 Pipestone, easy verticals)
- Build sales kit, demo, contract, T&Cs, privacy policy

- Pre-launch product compliance and legal review

Phase 1 — Marketing Agent Pilot (Months 2–4, July–August 2026)

- Onboard 5 pilot customers
- Launch Amplora chatbot in pilot territory with consumer marketing push
- Weekly cycle reviews with each pilot customer
- Document case studies and testimonials
- Decision gate at month 4: go/no-go on broader rollout

Phase 2 — Southwest Peach Expansion (Months 4–8, September 2026 – January 2027)

- Open marketing agent sales to all SW Peach businesses
- Target: 25–40 active customers by month 8
- Hire/contract first dedicated customer success person at month 6
- **Begin Phase 1.5 ad reach engineering** — build reach configuration, cross-territory tracking, reach calculator
- Refine pricing based on pilot data

Phase 1.5 — Ad Reach Launch (Months 8–12, February–April 2027)

- Phase 1.5 ad amplification goes live across SW Peach territory
- Sales reps trained on reach upsell motion
- Publisher revenue tracking dashboard live
- Sign 1–2 additional publisher partners
- Year-end target: 35–50 marketing agent customers in SW Peach, 75–100 across all territories

Phase 2 Engineering — (Months 12–18)

- Build Tier 4 inventory infrastructure
- First vertical integration: auto inventory management systems (DealerCenter, vAuto, AutoBase)
- Identify and approach first 3–5 Tier 4 dealer prospects
- Hire regional sales lead for Tier 4

Phase 2 — Inventory Tier Soft Launch (Months 18–24)

- Onboard first 5–10 Tier 4 dealers (auto vertical)
- Begin ag equipment integration
- Real estate / MLS integration scoping

Year 3 — Multi-Vertical Inventory Scale

- Tier 4 across auto, ag, real estate
- Expand to 5–7 territories
- 300–500 marketing agent customers, 30–80 Tier 4 customers
- Build out v2 marketing agent features (autonomous ad spend, email/SMS, photo network)

Key Milestones

- M2: 5 pilot customers signed and onboarded
- M3: First case studies; chatbot has 1,000+ MAU in pilot territory
- M6: 25+ active customers; first hire
- M12: 75–100 marketing agent customers; Phase 1.5 launched; 2–3 territories
- M18: Tier 4 platform built; first auto dealer integrations
- M24: 100–150 marketing agent customers + 5–15 Tier 4 + Phase 1.5 fully operational
- M36: \$1.35M–\$3M total ARR across all three product lines

12. Open Items and Decisions Needed

These remain unresolved and should be settled in coming weeks:

- **Brand application** — Amplora platform brand vs. publisher-branded customer surfaces ("Windom Marketing, powered by Amplora"); decision affects sales materials, dashboard, agent voice, and what publishers are licensing
- **Pilot customer recruitment** — target list and outreach owner; signed pilots needed within ~6 weeks of platform readiness
- **Website scope for Tier 2/3** — template auto-populated from Product Marketing Context vs. more custom build for businesses without an existing site

- **Multi-tenant learning architecture** — propagate insights across customers (anonymized) from day one or defer to v2; affects data model
- **V1 stop sign criteria** — quantitative success criteria for pilot decision gate AND quantitative kill criteria
- **Publisher contract template** — needs legal drafting; must address Phase 1.5 cross-territory revenue rules before Phase 1.5 launch
- **Pre-launch validation interviews** — three or four real conversations with target businesses where the offer is described and priced concretely
- **Sales kit production** — owner of building demo, pitch script, pricing sheet
- **Consumer-side launch marketing** — channels and budget for Amplora chatbot adoption push
- **Photography and visual asset strategy** — owner-provided + AI-generated; policy for businesses with no usable photos
- **Industry guardrails final list** — confer with legal; production-ready compliance filter
- **Backend language decision** — pending from prior project specification

This plan integrates strategic discussions through May 2026 and covers the marketing agent core product (v1), network-amplified display advertising (Phase 1.5), and Tier 4 inventory verticals (Phase 2). Specific numbers and timelines should be validated against detailed cost data, pilot customer feedback, and partner input. The plan is a working document and will be refined as the pilot progresses.